

cultural festival

Centre of Action

GURGAON Those who thought Gurgaon was only about glass-fronted malls and concrete-encased luxury lifestyles can think again. Epicentre promises to be the National Capital Region's new cultural hub. It houses an auditorium and a hall meant for art exhibitions and screening of films. Starting here on March 12 will be a festival which promises to be an impressive mix of the traditional and the modern.

On Day One, Sudha Raghuraman—a well-known face in the dance circuit as she sings for Bharatanatyam performances—will present a solo Carnatic music recital. Gaurav Mazumdar, a disciple of sitar legend Pandit Ravi Shankar, will perform on March 20. Mazumdar's album *East Meets West* was nominated for the Grammy's in 2004. On March 23, you can listen to a fusion performance by the Toxic Urban Groove.

Dance in its pure

traditional form can sometimes be more captivating than complex thematic presentations. Epicentre, run by Old World Hospitality, will also play host to a number of such performances. Witness a Bharatanatyam recital by Rasika Khanna, a disciple of Kalanidhi Narayanan and the legendary Balasaraswathi. On March 21, there will be a choreographed presentation, *Holi Ke Rang*, by Kalashram, conceptualised by Pandit Birju Maharaj and Saswati Sen.

Also on view at the gallery will be *Ceramic Scapes II*, an exhibition of ceramic sculptures by

Leena Batra, Sonia Ramaswamy Dhingra and Rekha Bajpe. On March 29 and 30, theatre buffs will get to watch Gabriel Garcia Marquez's play, *Erendira And Her Heartless Grandmother*, directed by Amal Allana. It is a poignant story of a young girl forced into prostitution by her grandmother. Don't miss the rich spread.

by **S. Sahaya Ranjit**



DIVERSE STRAINS: Khanna (above); Raghuraman (left); Mazumdar



MANPREET ROMANA

theatre

New Connections

BANGALORE *The Invisible River* is a play about the Ganga, considered holy by a majority of India's population. It is "a Goddess both revered and defiled". Written by Gautam Raja and directed by Ruchika Channana, the play seeks to explore the possibility of science and religion joining hands. The premise is set when a young scientist from Bangalore reaches Allahabad to investigate the belief that bacteriophages present in the river could help eradicate several diseases. This sets off a ripple effect that impacts several people in the country. With a cast of colourful characters set against the backdrop of Ganga, a symbol of power, the play reveals that in a country like India, everything is interconnected. Produced in collaboration with Theatrescience UK, as part of Theatrescience India—Imagining the Future, the production has incorporated inputs from the scientific advisor of the project, Dr Mukund Thattai of the National Centre for Biological Sciences. At Ranga Shankara. On from March 8.

by **Nirmala Ravindran**

ART OF SCIENCE: Artistes of *The Invisible River*



festival

Musical Treat

DELHI The ITC Sangeet Sammelan brings together the best of musicians on March 8 and 9. The festival will pay tribute to the Ustad of Delhi gharana—Ustad Chand Khan. The ITC Award this year will be presented to Sangeet Martand Pandit Jasraj. The sammelan will also see performances by



Girija Devi

some artistes including Malladi Brothers (Carnatic vocal), Rajhesh Vaidhya (Carnatic vocal), Girija Devi (Hindustani classical) and Manilal Nag (sitar). At Kamani Auditorium.